Cognitive Task Overview: Multiracial Reading the Mind in the Eyes Test

Contact: Info@ManyBrains.net
ManyBrains.net
TestMyBrain.org

TMB Test Name: TestMyBrain Multiracial Reading the Mind in the Eyes Test (MRMET)
Test Demo: standard version
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Acknowledgments: Actors of Boston's Company One Theatre

The Many Brains Project

The Many Brains Project, is a 501(c)(3) non-profit that supports TestMyBrain (TMB) in collaboration with the Laboratory for Brain and Cognitive Health Technology at McLean Hospital and Harvard Medical School. We currently support many different types of research studies through our infrastructure for cognitive assessment - these range in size from small lab-based pilot studies to large longitudinal, multisite clinical research studies with tens of thousands of participants. As TestMyBrain has been continuously in operation since 2008, we provide a stable and secure platform for hosting and delivering mobile and web-based cognitive assessment protocols. Through TestMyBrain.org, data have been collected from over 3.7 million participants in a *citizen science* framework that includes structured return of research results toward the development, validation, and normative characterization of cognitive measures. We currently support research and education at over 2,000 sites worldwide engaged in digital neuropsychological assessment.

CITATION

Please credit The Many Brains Project and TestMyBrain in any papers, posters, or publications related to the TMB tests or data collected by TMB tests.

- Example:
  - All tasks were selected from and hosted on The Many Brains Project's web-based cognitive testing platform, TestMyBrain (Germine et al., 2012; The Many Brains Project).
    - Germine, L., Nakayama, K., Duchaine, B. C., Chabris, C. F., Chatterjee, G., & Wilmer, J. B. (2012). Is the Web as good as the lab? Comparable performance from Web and lab in cognitive/perceptual experiments. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, *19*(5), 847-857.
    - The Many Brains Project. *TestMyBrain Cognitive Tests*. URL: www.manybrains.net

Test Overview

Background:
TestMyBrain Multiracial Reading the Mind in the Eyes Test (MRMET; Kim et al., 2024) is an adapted version of the Reading the Mind in the Eyes Test (RMET; Baron-Cohen et al., 2001), a widely used neuropsychiatric paradigm that measures theory of mind and social cognition. Important updates specific to the MRMET include: (1) racially inclusive stimuli, (2) nongendered answer choices, (3) ground-truth referenced answers, and (4) more accessible vocabulary.

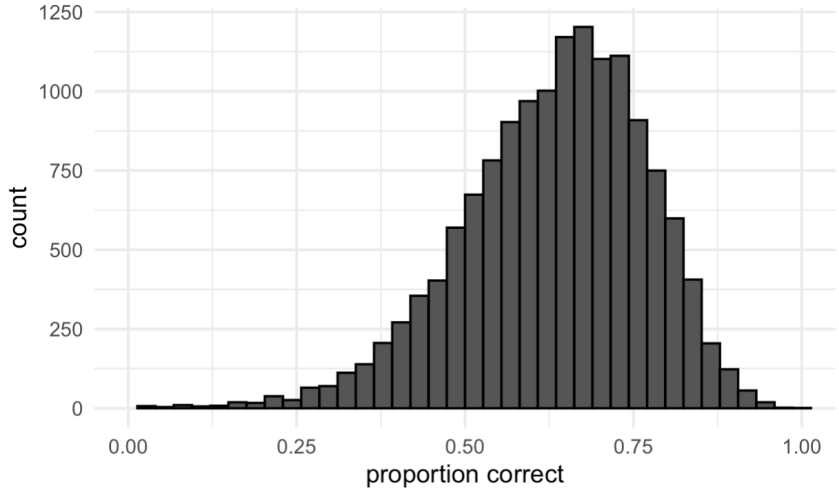
Task Parameters:
On each trial, participants view a photograph of the eyes and eyebrows of an actor expressing a mental state (e.g., *confident*). Participants are asked to identify the mental state pictured in the photograph by selecting one of four response options, which included the depicted mental state and three mental states not depicted in the photo (e.g., *disappointed*, *confused*, *uneasy*). Participants complete 1 unscored practice trial and 37 test trials. Participants are required to respond within 30 seconds, after which a message appears informing them that they were taking too long to respond, at which point the trial is repeated.

Primary Outcome:
The suggested primary outcome for the test is the proportion of test trials answered correctly (accuracy).

User Input:
Participants respond either by touching (touch-compatible devices) or clicking their selections.

Alternate Task Versions: A 10-item short form is described in Kim et al. (2024).

Psychometrics:
- **Reliability**: In Kim et al. (2024), the task was reported to have a Cronbach's alpha of .71.
- **Score distribution**:



References:

Baron-Cohen, S., Wheelwright, S., Hill, J., Raste, Y., & Plumb, I. (2001). The "Reading the Mind in the Eyes" test revised version: A study with normal adults, and adults with Asperger syndrome or high-functioning autism. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry*, *42*(2), 241-251.

Kim, H. A., Kaduthodil, J., Strong, R. W., Germine, L. T., Cohan, S., & Wilmer, J. B. (2024). Multiracial Reading the Mind in the Eyes Test (MRMET): An inclusive version of an influential measure. *Behavior Research Methods*, *56*(6), 5900-5917.